



Skills of Effective Communication

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LECTURE (4)

Skills of Effective Communication

- **A-Skills that support in keeping the focus on the client**
- **B- Skills that support effective listening**
- **C- Skills that help with giving information**



Skills of Effective Communication

A-Skills that support in keeping the focus on the client:

- Looking and listening to cues.

Cues are hints and can be words, gestures or body language. Noticing verbal and non-verbal cues is important to understanding the client/patient's needs.



- **Asking relevant questions**

- **Ask** open & closed ended questions
- **Ask** open questions as much as possible (esp. at the start) For example: How are you?
- **Asking** open directive questions: for example: How are you since I last saw you? ‘You said you are not with it; can you tell me more about that?’
- **Ask** probing questions
 - ✓ Clarify: What do you mean by that
 - ✓ Justify: What makes you think of that
 - ✓ Check accuracy: you definitely took 3 tab /day





AVOID

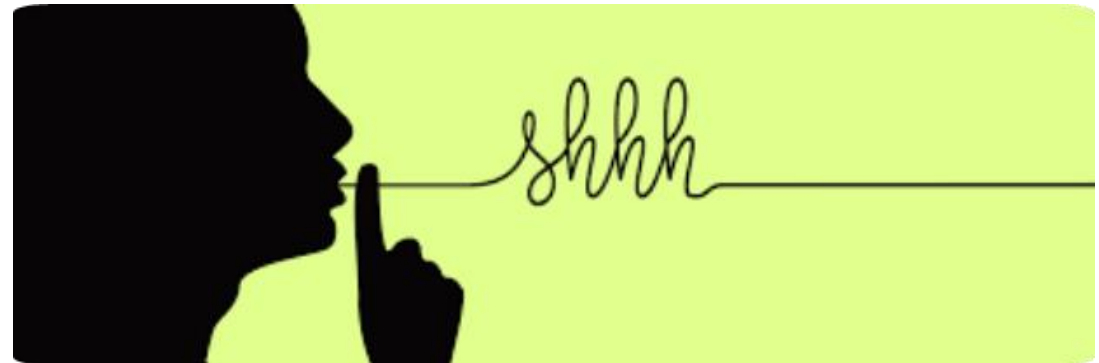
- ✓ **Talk more than the client/patient**
- ✓ **confusing & complicated questions**
- ✓ **Ignoring questions of the client/patient**

- **Psychological focus**

- ✓ Asking the clients open ended questions about feelings.
- ✓ Recognizing and responding to emotions, feelings and concerns.
- ✓ Client/patients appreciate healthcare professionals asking about their feelings.



- Using pauses and silence
- Pauses and silence provide a slower pace and will help the person to engage in the conversation and give them time to think about what they want to say.
- Using minimal prompts.
- Use small, encouraging words and gestures. For example, nodding or saying, 'go on'.



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- **Screening**
 - For example: asking the question, “Is there something else?” before continuing with the discussion.



- **Clarifying**
- For example: asking the question ‘you said you are not with it, from what you say, it sounds like it is hard to concentrate?’
- **Negotiating**
- Negotiating and asking permission. For example: Would it be okay to talk about what is worrying you?’



